

SECTION 1. *The California Driver's License*

A California driver's license allows you to drive on public roads.

Before you can get a driver's license in California, you are required to pass the knowledge and behind-the-wheel drive tests based on information in this handbook.

You must have the correct license to drive your vehicle type. Most people need a noncommercial Class C driver's license. To operate commercial vehicles, motorcycles, and other types of vehicles, you must have a different class of license.

For information on vehicles covered by a Class C, visit [**dmv.ca.gov/dl**](https://dmv.ca.gov/dl).

CARD DESIGNATIONS

REAL ID Driver's License

Beginning May 2025, your driver's license, or identification (ID) card must be REAL ID compliant if you use it to:

- Board an airplane for domestic flights.
- Enter military bases.
- Enter most federal facilities.

Visit [**dmv.ca.gov/realid**](https://dmv.ca.gov/realid) to learn more about applying for a REAL ID.

Driver's Licenses for Undocumented Residents

California offers driver's licenses for all residents regardless of immigration status. For more information, visit [**dmv.ca.gov/dl**](https://dmv.ca.gov/dl).

Organ and Tissue Donor

For information, visit [**donateLIFECalifornia.org**](https://donateLIFECalifornia.org).

Veterans

Visit [**dmv.ca.gov/veterans**](https://dmv.ca.gov/veterans) to learn more about the requirements and benefits of a Veteran designation.

ID Cards

ID cards are issued for identification purposes to eligible persons of any age. They do not permit you to drive. To get an ID, you must provide your identity document, residency documents, and social security number.

Visit [**dmv.ca.gov/id-cards**](https://dmv.ca.gov/id-cards) to complete an ID card application and get information on current acceptable documents and reduced-fee, no-fee, or senior ID cards.